

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 2-3 · with clues

Name _____

Date _____

Use the clues. Change **one letter** each step to make the word that matches the clue.

Ladder 1

B I T E

Start here

1

It has two wheels and pedals

2

To cook in an oven, like bread

3

Lots of fresh water with land all around

4

A narrow road

L A N D

Finish here

Ladder 2

M O V E

Start here

1

A gentle bird that coos

2

To jump into water head first

3

Cubes with dots that you roll in games

4

Small white grains you cook and eat

R I D E

Finish here

Ladder 3

B E A T

Start here

1

It floats and carries people on water

2

A tall shoe for rain or snow

3

It has pages for you to read

4

You can hang your coat on it

H O O D

Finish here

Word Ladders

Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

B I T E

Start here

1 B I K E

It has two wheels and pedals

2 B A K E

To cook in an oven, like bread

3 L A K E

Lots of fresh water with land all around

4 L A N E

A narrow road

L A N D

Finish here

Ladder 2

M O V E

Start here

1 D O V E

A gentle bird that coos

2 D I V E

To jump into water head first

3 D I C E

Cubes with dots that you roll in games

4 R I C E

Small white grains you cook and eat

R I D E

Finish here

Ladder 3

B E A T

Start here

1 B O A T

It floats and carries people on water

2 B O O T

A tall shoe for rain or snow

3 B O O K

It has pages for you to read

4 H O O K

You can hang your coat on it

H O O D

Finish here